

Missing in action

Hey guys,
I am very disappointed that you have not bothered to include *America's Army* in your Playware CDs. How can you ignore a game which is free for download and is based on the legendary Unreal 3D game engine? Please don't say that you can't spare 240 MB of space on your Playware CD.
Keith Sebastian
Via e-mail

Hi Keith,
Ordinarily we don't carry such large software since we do have 'limited' space on the CDs and need to cater to a large audience that has varying preferences and needs. Luckily for you, *America's Army* was the winner of the August-September 2002 By Demand poll, and is being included with this issue of Digit. Find it in the Arena section of the Playware CD.

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Gaming for a living

Dear Vinit,
I have just completed computer engineering and now want to enter the world of computer gaming. The problem I am facing is the lack of information regarding this field. My first concern is to do something in India and I have contacted many people, including professors at MIT, about the animation field, but they know little. Please suggest something because I am totally confused and there is no guidance.

Jaidev Singh
Via e-mail



Dear Jaidev,
In a nutshell, game development is made up of three streams: design, programming and art. The safest route you could take is by going the animation way (art). A good animator is a very important asset to a game development company. Moreover, the skillset carries over to the film and broadcast industry (ads, serials and the like). Of course, animation is not an easy subject to tackle—it requires sound knowledge of biology, physics and mathematics. Plus you would need to familiarise yourself with 3D modelling packages such as 3D Studio Max and Maya. For more information, check out www.gamedev.net.

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Cookie technology

Dear Vinit,
A reader wrote to you regarding advertisements of TV brands and you replied that these are a part of technology and it also reduces your production cost, which is why you are giving them advertising space. Now you are providing space for Britannia cookies since two issues. Are these cookies digital or related to technology in any way?

Pravesh Tabaria
Via e-mail

Hi Vinit,
Though I don't like the increasing number of advertisement pages in Digit, the ads are helpful in keeping me informed about the latest products. But I fail to find a link between Britannia's Pure Magic cookies and technology.

Kunal Datta
Via e-mail

Dear Pravesh and Kunal,
There's no digital technology in Britannia's cookies—they just taste good :-)

digit

The (in)visible player

Hi Digit,
Your hardware test of MP3 players in the September 2002 issue was very good, but you missed out the Mercury MP3/CD/VCD Player, which was advertised just next to the test! Please test it because I want to buy an MP3 player and my purchase is dependent on your recommendations.

Anuj Goyal
Via e-mail

Hi Anuj,
Yes, it did look quite silly to have an MP3 player being advertised with-in the test, especially when it's not being reviewed! But this was a pure and simple logistical error—the Mercury player has been reviewed in this issue on page 82.

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Your vote counts

Q. Which amongst these four comparison tests would you like covered in an upcoming issue of Digit?

Linux	Gaming	Mobile Computing
40%	44%	16%

Whew! This was a close one, but then games it is!

This month's question:

"What type of interface would you prefer on the Digit CDs?"

- HTML
- Shockwave/Flash
- Doesn't matter. I'm only interested in the software

Log on to www.thinkdigit.com and vote on it